

ECON-: [course title] [disc number] — [quarter, year]

Graduate instructor information

Name: [name]

Office: [office]

Email: [email]

Office Hours: [day, time]

Course Supervisor: [name]

Section information (*optional*)

Course: [disc number]

Date: [day]

Time: [time]

Classroom: [location]

Section objectives

One hour a week discussion section to supplement the lectures of ECON-. Discussion sections are the only time you will have to discuss the content of the course, ask questions, and exercise critical analysis in a group, with relation to the course material. Sections will primarily be a time to build your understanding of core concepts through discussion and practice problems. Learning to speak through a topic, or explain it to others, is a critical part of the learning process. The format differs from lecture and no new material is presented. Students can prepare:

- Come prepared with questions you have tried or are stuck on from the problem sets or exams to review in more detail.
- Practice applying mathematics, particularly game theory, to economic theories.
- Learn to [self] assess the mathematical solutions and concepts to economic problems.
- Engage in classroom discussion with peers on the theories of intermediate microeconomics.
- Ask questions related to real world applications, new research or context.

Principles of community

In our discussion, I expect us to engage in open dialogue to ultimately deepen our understanding the topics of this course. I encourage everyone to have patience and courage when speaking in class, and always respect for others. An important aim of our classroom interactions will be for us to increase our facility to discuss economic theory and its applications, where reasonable people may hold diverse perspectives as there is both evolving evidence and disagreement within microeconomics. I ask all members of this class to:

- Be open to and interested in the views of others.

- Consider the possibility that your views may change over the course of the term.
- Listen to each other's opinions and communicate in a respectful manner.
- Ground your comments in the texts we are studying. Referring frequently to the course notes, readings and textbooks as the focus of questions and comments is an effective way to ensure respectful and evidence-based discussion.

Class attendance

Participation is not graded and discussion sections are not mandatory, but highly recommended to gain a mastery of the material through discussion and practice problems. Lecture attendance is critical to course success. If you are unable to attend a discussion section, you are welcome to attend my other section, DISC01B on Wednesday from 14:40 to 15:45 (or any other offered section). Please try to attend the discussion from the start time of the course, as coming late to class may disrupt other students.

Homework

The purpose of homework is to work through common models and learn to apply economic concepts. Completing all the homework problems is the best way to practice and prepare for quizzes and exams. I can review problems and assist on homework problems during section time and office hours. *Late submissions will not be accepted. An extension may only be granted given you contact the TA and professor before the assignment due date.*

Math & other help

If you need help, there are many resources available to help you. If you are struggling, please attend my office hours or send an email as soon as possible. Do not wait to bring issues, course related or otherwise, to my attention. I plan to respond to emails related to the course within 48 hours. If you cannot attend office hours, send me an email, at [email], to arrange a different time for us to meet.

The economics department and you

If you need help on planning your coursework for the year, or selecting courses for your major, you can reach out to undergraduate advising at [insert your url]. The Economics department also offers undergraduate advising at [insert your url] for economics majors or those interested in majoring in economics. The best way to succeed in the department is to utilize the resources available to you, make connections with graduate student instructors, professors and your colleagues in the course.

If you are unsure about majoring in economics or a similar field, I am happy to speak to you about your interest in economics. There can be specific challenges for students from underrepresented backgrounds, including race, gender and class. As a graduate student instructor, I am always available to discuss any issues or challenges you may be uniquely facing, and I will do my best to address the challenges (and identify available support) for any students who are interested.

Use of AI and other LLMs

The application and utility of AI in economics is still evolving. I acknowledge the practical uses of AI to save time on tedious tasks or enhance learning outcomes, and I acknowledge healthy and practical AI use may confer future employment benefit on students. I am committed to encouraging ethical and functional use of AI tools. Within this class, you are welcome to use foundation models (ChatGPT, GPT, DALL-E, Stable Diffusion, Midjourney, GitHub Copilot, and anything after) to support your learning of economics theory, as AI may provide you with supplemental and alternative forms of engagement or review of course materials. AI may provide additional or alternative explanations or an organization of the concepts and thoughts that support a deeper comprehension of the subject for yourself.

As a general reminder, material generated by AI models may be inaccurate, incomplete, or otherwise problematic. Beware that use may also stifle your own independent thinking and creativity.

To provide clear boundaries on the use of AI for ECON-, I have provided a list of *do's and don't's*. This policy aims to ensure the academic integrity and originality of your work, as submitted work is subjected to the university's plagiarism and academic integrity policy.

Do not use AI in this context:

- You must never submit any work generated by an AI program as your own for a grade. This includes solutions to problem sets, quizzes, questions posed by instructors, or exams.
- Plugging in homework assignments, quiz questions, or ungraded questions directly into the AI platform and subsequently copying the solutions or solution steps produced. This type of use will stifle your ability to think logically about economic problems and how to solve them, inhibiting your success in the course.
- Putting the material of the course (lecture notes, textbook chapters, or readings) and asking AI to *summarize, extract key points, or identify the most important information*. The material presented in the course must be understood as a whole and in connection with the wider economic theory, and cannot be distilled to a few facts.
- Exclusively for exam preparation. Foundational models may be able to summarize materials (words), but it is up to you to determine, from your interpretation and review of lecture materials, what information is most relevant, and the way it may be presented in an exam context. Additional practice problems can be found in the textbook.

Use AI:

- Refine and provide high quality prompts (questions) to AI related to course material. This could involve feeding some course information to AI, asking detailed questions about a narrow economic theory, concept or proof. If you provide minimum effort prompts, you will get low quality results.
- Prepare questions from lecture materials where you want to engage further.
- For more mathematical questions in the homeworks or quizzes, ask AI if there exists other mathematical approaches to the same question. For example, you could ask, "*is it possible to demonstrate proof of concept X in an alternative way?*". Then, check other source material or bring the alternative solution to section or office hours for review.

- You may ask AI if your solution to additional questions (beyond course assignments) are correct and why. Be aware: these models can make inaccurate statements. You can bring questions to me in office hours for review.
- If you choose to use AI for any discussion section, please provide disclosure. Like any other source, AI use should be acknowledged (cited).
- If you want to find new or divergent economic topics tangential to course material, use AI to identify starting points or people who you can further research. For e.g., if you want to know more about game theory, you may ask AI, "*Who did John Nash work with? Who cited John Nash? What were some foundational texts for game theory?*"

Grading

Please submit all work on time for grading. The following will hold:

- **Late work (without prior approval from instructor) will not be accepted.**
- **I cannot offer re-grading on any assignment or exam.** Please contact the course instructor if you have a concern on grading.

If you submit work that appears to have been written using unauthorized sources, I will refer you to the course instructor. Please be aware if you are caught cheating, the instructor may give you a zero on the assignment and they may need to report the incident to the university administration for further sanctions.